

# Younghyun Lee

Department of Political Science · University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign  
605 E. Springfield Ave., Champaign, IL 61820  
✉ [yl78@illinois.edu](mailto:yl78@illinois.edu) | [youngyunlee.com](http://youngyunlee.com) | ☎ +1-217-377-7547

## EDUCATION

---

**University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign** Urbana, IL  
Ph.D. Candidate, Political Science 2027 (expected)  
*Dissertation:* Beyond Contact: How Interactions with Natives Shape Immigrant Political Integration  
*Committee:* Cara Wong (Chair), Matt Winters, Jake Bowers, Rana Khoury

**Korea University** Seoul, Korea  
MA, Political Science and International Relations 2019  
BA, French Language and Literature; International Studies 2016

## ACADEMIC APPOINTMENT

---

**Mannheim Centre for European Social Research (MZES)** Mannheim, Germany  
Visiting Doctoral Fellow May 2025

**Immigration Research Initiative (IRI), Concordia University** Montreal, QC  
Visiting Doctoral Fellow (PI: Antoine Bilodeau) Fall 2024

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

---

Immigrant Integration, Intergroup Relations, Identity Politics, Political Behavior, Political Psychology, Party Politics, Europe, Comparative Politics

## PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

---

1. **Younghyun Lee** and Sanghoon Kim-Leffingwell. 2026. [Engaged but Targeted? How Immigrants Vote Against Anti-Immigrant Agendas in Europe](#). *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies*, 52:13, 3323-3347.
2. Seyoung Jung, **Younghyun Lee**, and Cara Wong. 2025. [What Can Dual Citizens Teach Us about Political Engagement?](#) *Political Science Research and Methods*, 1–23.
3. **Younghyun Lee** and Nam-Kook Kim. 2019. [Divergent Paths of Integration in the Post-Multicultural Era: Interculturalism in Spain and Civic Integration in France](#). *Journal of European Union Studies* 53: 3–48.

## BOOK CHAPTERS

---

1. **Younghyun Lee**, Florencia Piñeyrúa, Christian Czymara, and Max Weber. 2026. [Linguistic Polarization in Minority Representation: Analyzing Parliamentary Speeches in Germany and the UK \(1980–2021\)](#). In Lorenz, J., Keijzer, M., Bojanowski, M. (Eds.), *Computational Social Science of Social Cohesion and Polarization*. Springer.

## WORKING PAPERS

---

1. Not All Contact Is Equal: Interaction with Natives and Immigrant Political Integration in Hostile Contexts (*Job Market Paper*)
2. Cross-Ethnic Engagement and Political Integration in Quebec (*with Antoine Bilodeau*)
3. Is Six Degrees of Separation Five Too Many? The Limits of Indirect Contact (*with Cara Wong*)
4. Inter-Minority Attitudes Among Refugees in Germany (*with Christian Czymara and Irena Kogan*)

## WORK IN PROGRESS

---

1. Well-Integrated Immigrants Without a Sense of Belonging?
2. "Not the Same Kind of Immigrant!" Boundary-Making Among Co-National Immigrants
3. When Do Losers Defy Electoral Outcomes? (*with Jonghoon Lee*)
4. Who Counts as Patriotic? (*with Cara Wong*)

## SELECTED FELLOWSHIPS & GRANTS

---

|                                                                           |            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Graduate College Dissertation Completion Fellowship (\$25,000)            | 2026-2027  |
| APSA Summer Centennial Center Research Grant (\$2,500)                    | 2026       |
| Marion Morse Wood Fellowship in Interpersonal Communication (\$12,000)    | 2025-2026  |
| Conference Travel Grants, University of Illinois                          | 2022-2026  |
| PRIEC Travel Grant, UNT (2023) & UCSB (2026)                              | 2023, 2026 |
| Ferber & Sudman Dissertation Awards for Survey Research (\$2,500)         | 2025       |
| Mannheim Centre for European Social Research Visiting Fellowship (€4,500) | 2025       |
| Graduate College Henderson Fellowship (\$6,000)                           | 2024-2025  |
| Graduate College Dissertation Travel Grant (\$5,000)                      | 2024       |
| Immigration Research Initiative Visiting Fellowship (CAD 8,000)           | 2024       |
| Graduate College Kneier Fellowship (\$7,000)                              | 2022-2024  |
| German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD) Travel Grant (€1,000)             | 2023       |
| European Parliament Trainee Fellowship, Korea Foundation (€7,500)         | 2018       |

## AWARDS

---

|                                                             |      |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| Rita and Leonard Ogren Prize for Academic Achievement, UIUC | 2022 |
| Best Graduate Thesis Proposal, Korea University             | 2018 |

## TEACHING INTERESTS

---

Migration and Citizenship, Race and Ethnic Politics, Europe/EU Politics, Comparative Politics, Research Methods, Survey Research, Mixed Method

## TEACHING & MENTORING

---

### Instructor of Record | *University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign*

- PS201 US Racial and Ethnic Politics (online) Fall 2023, Spring 2025
- PS385 Politics of the European Union (online) Summer 2024

### Teaching Assistant | *University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign*

- PS270 Introduction to Political Theory\* Spring 2022
- PS282 Governing Globalization\* Fall 2021

### Research Mentor | *University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign*

- Undergraduate Research Apprenticeship Program (URAP) 2025-2027

### Teaching Assistant | *Korea University*

- POLI238 Law and Political Thought Fall 2017
- POLI361 Identity Politics in Europe and Asia Spring 2017

\* Recognized on the UIUC List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent

## INVITED TALKS

---

1. "Beyond Contact: How Intergroup Relations with Natives Shape Immigrant Political Integration."  
– *Mittelbau Kolloquium*, Mannheim Centre for European Social Research, Germany (May 2025)

## 2. “The Role of Contact with Natives in Political Integration of Immigrants.”

- *Political Behavior Workshop*, McGill University, Montreal (Oct 2024)
- *Initiative de Recherche sur l’Immigration Seminar*, Concordia University, Montreal (Oct 2024)

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND WORKSHOPS

---

|                                                                         |                        |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| American Political Science Association Annual Meeting                   | 2024, 2025, 2026       |
| Politics of Race, Immigration, and Ethnicity Consortium                 | 2023, 2026             |
| Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting                    | 2022, 2023, 2025, 2026 |
| Political Identities in Europe, University of Amsterdam                 | 2025                   |
| APSA Dissertation Workshop (European Politics, Citizenship & Migration) | 2025                   |
| European Social Survey Conference                                       | 2024                   |
| European Union Studies Association                                      | 2023                   |
| Washington-Illinois Student Exchange                                    | 2022                   |
| Illinois European Union Studies Conference                              | 2022                   |

## FIELD RESEARCH

---

|                                                                           |             |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Germany:</b> Survey Data Analysis at DIW Berlin                        | Winter 2025 |
| <b>Belgium and Germany:</b> Interviews with Syrian and Turkish immigrants | Spring 2025 |
| <b>Germany:</b> Pre-dissertation fieldwork                                | Summer 2023 |

## SKILLS & ADDITIONAL TRAINING

---

|                                                                                                 |          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Languages:</b> Korean, English, French (advanced), Russian (intermediate), German (beginner) |          |
| <b>Programming:</b> R, RMarkdown, L <sup>A</sup> T <sub>E</sub> X, Python, Tableau, Qualtrics   |          |
| BIGSSS Summer Schools in Computational Social Science (Bremen, Germany)                         | Jul 2023 |

## SERVICE

---

|                                                                           |           |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Reviewer:</b> <i>Political Behavior</i>                                |           |
| <b>Conference Discussant:</b> MPSA 2026, APSA 2025                        |           |
| <b>Coordinator:</b> Comparative Politics Workshop, University of Illinois | 2022-2023 |
| <b>Program Committee:</b> PRIEC at University of Illinois                 | 2022      |
| <b>Board Member:</b> PSGSA, University of Illinois                        | 2021-2022 |

## ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

---

|                                                                                      |           |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Research Assistant</b> , University of Illinois, Urbana, Illinois (PI: Cara Wong) | 2022–2026 |
| <b>Full-Time Researcher</b> , East Asia Institute, Seoul, South Korea                | 2019–2020 |
| <b>Trainee</b> , European Parliamentary Research Service, Brussels, Belgium          | 2018      |
| <b>Research Assistant</b> , Korea University, Seoul, South Korea (PI: Nam-Kook Kim)  | 2017      |

## REFERENCES

---

|                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Cara J. Wong</b> (Professor)<br>Department of Political Science<br>University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign<br><a href="mailto:carawong@illinois.edu">carawong@illinois.edu</a> | <b>Matthew S. Winters</b> (Professor)<br>Department of Political Science<br>University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign<br><a href="mailto:mwinters@illinois.edu">mwinters@illinois.edu</a> |
| <b>Jacob W. Bowers</b> (Professor)<br>Department of Political Science and Statistics<br><a href="mailto:jwbowers@illinois.edu">jwbowers@illinois.edu</a>                          | <b>Rana B. Khoury</b> (Assistant Professor)<br>Department of Political Science<br><a href="mailto:rbkhoury@illinois.edu">rbkhoury@illinois.edu</a>                                      |

*Last Updated: August 15, 2026*